



WORKSHOP PACK / 00

# Start here

Sixty minutes. Four patterns. One file to open. One working thing to take home.

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**Event**  
Finance of the Future

**Date**  
Wednesday 29 July 2026

**Venue**  
Tactix, Center City

01 / THE HOUR

# What happens, and what you leave with

You leave with one working thing. Not a demo you watched. An instruction you built, tested twice, and can use at your desk tomorrow morning.

| TIME     | WHAT               | WHAT YOU DO                                                                       |
|----------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0 to 5   | Three ground rules | Listen. It is two minutes and one of them keeps you out of trouble.               |
| 5 to 10  | Find your pattern  | Almost every problem in this room is one of four. Pick yours, move to that table. |
| 10 to 40 | Build              | Open your guide, paste the scaffold, fill the brackets, run it.                   |
| 40 to 50 | Test               | Run it a second time on different data. This is the step that proves it.          |
| 50 to 60 | Show three         | Three people show what they built. Everyone else takes their instruction home.    |

02 / THE RULES

# Three of them

ONE

**Use public or made-up data. Nothing real.** You are on venue wifi with a consumer account in a room of people you just met. Make up a sample with the same structure as your real file: same columns, same field names, invented values. Your instruction cannot tell the difference, because it works on structure, not on truth. The public company figures in the data pack are safe by definition, because the company published them itself.

TWO

**You are not starting from a blank page.** Four guides, four patterns, four scaffolds ready to paste. Find your pattern in Section 03, open that guide, and start from the scaffold. Nobody in this room should spend ten minutes staring at an empty box.

### THREE

**Grab a helper. That is literally what they are for.** Interrupt them. Wave them over mid-sentence. The failure mode of every workshop is people sitting quietly stuck, and it is the only way to waste this hour.

## 03 / YOUR PATTERN

# Which guide is yours

Read the four descriptions. Pick the one that made you nod. If two fit, pick the one you do more often. Then open that one file and stay in it. Everything you need is inside it.

|   | PATTERN                             | THE SHAPE                                               | YOU ARE HERE IF                                                                                                                      |
|---|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A | <b>The weekly report</b><br>File 02 | Scattered sources in, one clean recurring document out. | You rebuild the same update every week from the same places. Cash briefs, status updates, committee pre-reads, month-end commentary. |
| B | <b>Find and pull out</b><br>File 03 | Messy documents in, the specific answer out.            | The answer exists and is buried. Data rooms, agreement stacks, drive searches, receipt hunting, data quality checks.                 |
| C | <b>Fill the template</b><br>File 04 | Details in, finished document out.                      | Same document, new details, over and over. Invoices, quotes, engagement letters, onboarding packets, applications.                   |
| D | <b>Sort and route</b><br>File 05    | Items in, classified and prioritised out.               | Things arrive and you decide what each one is. Deal flow, inbox triage, expense coding, reconciliation exceptions, screening.        |

## Then pick FINANCE or GENERAL

Each pattern has two versions of the same guide. They differ only in what the practice data is about.

| VERSION        | THE WORLD IT USES                                                                                                 | TAKE IT IF                                                                                        |
|----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FINANCE</b> | Northbank Advisors, an invented advisory firm, plus real reported figures from a real public asset manager.       | You work in or near finance, accounting, investment or advisory. The vocabulary is already yours. |
| <b>GENERAL</b> | Fairmount Studio, an invented 14-person Philadelphia design and web studio. Projects, quotes, invoices, an inbox. | You do not work in finance. No financial literacy required at any point.                          |

#### THE GENERAL VERSION IS NOT THE EASY VERSION

Same pattern, same four traps, in the same places, at the same difficulty. The only difference is whether the numbers are called fee-earning AUM or billable utilisation. If the finance vocabulary would cost you ten minutes of decoding, that is ten minutes you are not spending building. Take GENERAL and do not think about it again.

#### GENUINELY CANNOT PICK A PATTERN?

Answer this out loud to a helper and they will place you in about ten seconds: **"Walk me through your Monday morning. What do you open first, and what do you do with it?"** Do not spend the build window choosing a problem.

# What is in this pack

YOU OPEN ONE FILE TONIGHT

Your guide. That is it. The instruction, the data, the answer key and the blank version for your own work are all inside it. Nothing to cross-reference, nothing to download twice.

| FILE | WHAT IT IS                                                 | WHEN YOU OPEN IT                                                                                                                                                           |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 00   | Start here                                                 | This. Right now.                                                                                                                                                           |
| 01   | Foundations                                                | Prompt engineering, the data rule, MCP connectors, scheduled agents, agentic workflows. Read Section 03 tonight if you have five minutes. Read the rest on the train home. |
| 02   | Guide A, the weekly report<br>FINANCE and GENERAL versions | If you are pattern A. Open one version, ignore the other.                                                                                                                  |
| 03   | Guide B, find and pull out<br>FINANCE and GENERAL versions | If you are pattern B.                                                                                                                                                      |
| 04   | Guide C, fill the template<br>FINANCE and GENERAL versions | If you are pattern C.                                                                                                                                                      |
| 05   | Guide D, sort and route<br>FINANCE and GENERAL versions    | If you are pattern D.                                                                                                                                                      |
| 06   | Data sources reference                                     | Only if you want to see where a real number came from. You do not need it to build anything.                                                                               |

## How your guide is laid out

| SECTION             | WHAT IT DOES                                                                                                                 |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 Diagnosis        | Four ticks to confirm you are in the right guide.                                                                            |
| 02 Start here       | Two boxes, three steps. The whole mechanic in one page.                                                                      |
| 03 The instruction  | Copy this into the top box. Complete, no brackets, ready to run.                                                             |
| 04 The data         | Copy this into the bottom box. Press run.                                                                                    |
| 05 Run it and check | The answer key. Did it hold shape, did it catch the traps.                                                                   |
| 06 to 10            | What you just built, how to point it at your own work, the blank scaffold, troubleshooting, and where it goes after tonight. |

## About the data

**One thing in this pack is real.** The reported figures for Hamilton Lane Incorporated (Nasdaq: HLNE), the private markets asset manager headquartered in Conshohocken. They appear inside the FINANCE versions of guides A and B, and every figure is sourced in file 06. Real data, published by the company itself, so there is no confidentiality question. That is exactly what makes it a good sandbox.

**Everything else is invented.** Northbank Advisors and Fairmount Studio are not real firms. Their clients, invoices, weekly numbers, inboxes and memos do not exist, and no real person appears anywhere in the data. They are built to look and break like the real thing, including the parts that are wrong on purpose.

### THERE ARE FOUR TRAPS IN YOUR DATA, DELIBERATELY

A missing field. A figure that contradicts another. Two numbers that look inconsistent and are both correct because they are as of different dates. And, in guide D, an inbound item containing instructions aimed at your classifier. Every guide has them, and Section 05 of your guide tells you exactly what catching them looks like.

An instruction that produces beautiful output and walks past all four is worse than no instruction, because you will trust it. Finding the traps is the actual skill tonight.

# Who to grab

| WHO                                 | WHAT THEY COVER                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Jacky Petit-Homme                   | Advisory, client-facing and finance work. Pattern A, and anyone from a firm working out what is even worth automating.           |
| Fifunmi Familusi                    | Anything technical. Things that break, will not connect, or need an engineer's eye. Patterns B and D.                            |
| Neil Rayarao and Eyob Treiser Brown | People stuck on <i>what</i> to build or how to phrase it. If you have not picked a pattern in five minutes, wave one of us down. |
| Anyone at your table                | Everyone at your table has the same shape of problem as you. That is why you are sitting there. Use them.                        |

# What finished looks like

- ☐ An instruction saved somewhere you can find it tomorrow. Not in a chat you will lose.
- ☐ Run twice, on two different inputs, in two fresh sessions.
- ☐ Both outputs have the same shape. You could paste them into the same template without editing a heading.
- ☐ It caught the trap. It said "not found", or "missing", or flagged the conflict, instead of producing a confident number.
- ☐ You know the one thing you would fix next.

THE LAST ONE IS THE REAL ONE

Nothing you build in fifty minutes is finished. The people who get value out of tonight are the ones who use the thing once on Monday, notice exactly where it was wrong, and change two lines. That loop is the whole skill. Everything in these guides is just a faster start.